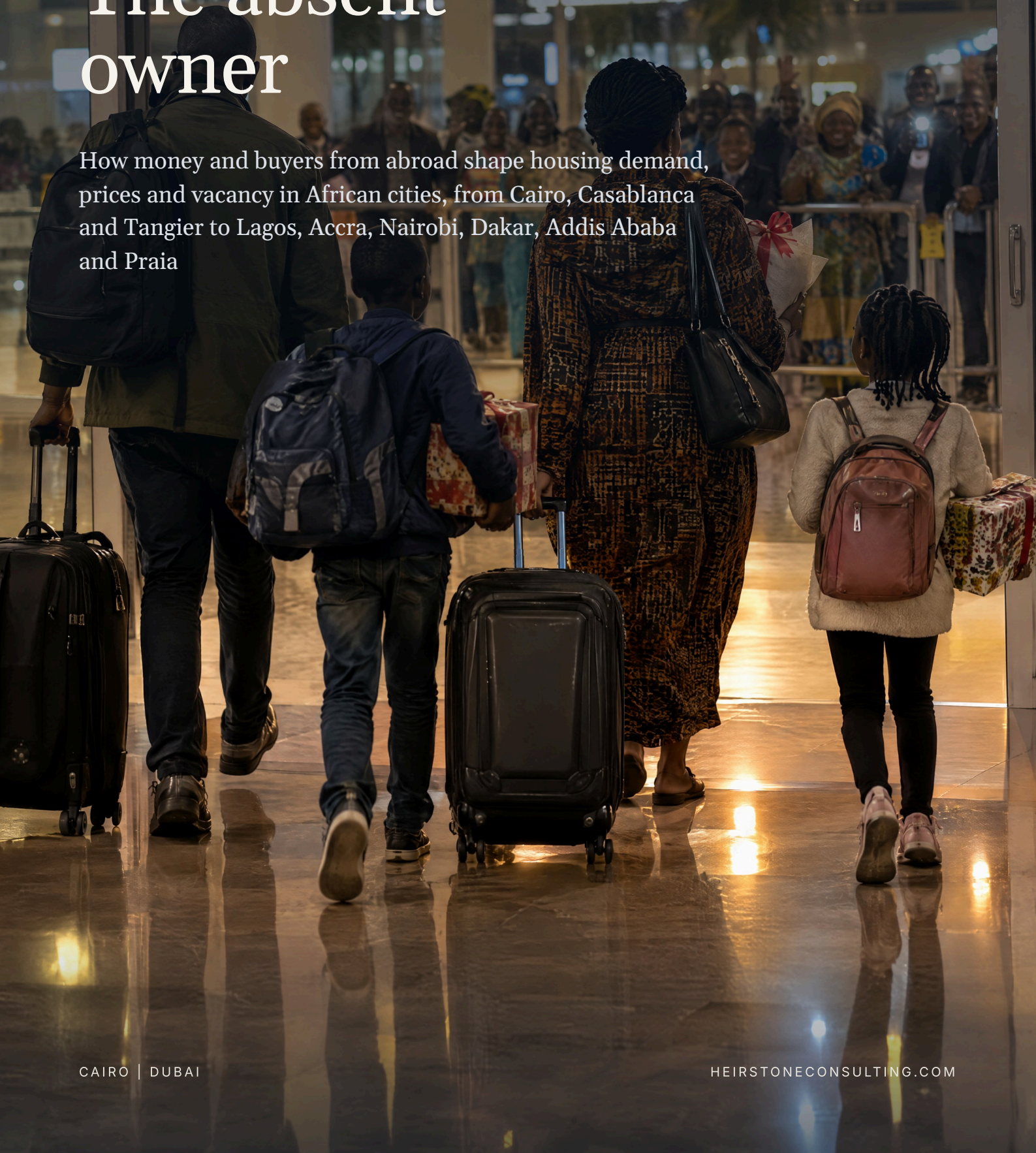




DIASPORA BUYERS

The absent owner

How money and buyers from abroad shape housing demand, prices and vacancy in African cities, from Cairo, Casablanca and Tangier to Lagos, Accra, Nairobi, Dakar, Addis Ababa and Praia



SIX NUMBERS FROM THIS REPORT

US\$36.5bn

sent home by Egyptians abroad in the fiscal year to June 2025, a record and 66% more than a year earlier

9.9x

Nigeria's remittances as a multiple of its net foreign direct investment, 2015 to 2024 combined

1.159m

homes closed because the household lives abroad, counted by Egypt's 2017 census, the only census we found in our twelve markets to measure them

+89%

rise in New Cairo apartment asking prices in pounds from May 2021 to March 2024; for buyers earning in dollars the same homes cost 38% less

89%

bank deposits of Moroccans living abroad as a share of Morocco's outstanding housing loans, March 2026

29%

of Cabo Verde's dwellings were for seasonal use or vacant at the 2021 census

CONTENTS

	What we found	3
1	Bigger than FDI, smaller than aid	4
2	Four ways to buy from abroad	7
3	The devaluation discount	11
4	Closed because the family is abroad	14
5	Selling to citizens abroad	18
6	The Heirstone Diaspora Housing Monitor	21
7	What to do	27
	Notes, sources and definitions	29

ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises developers, investors, lenders and governments in the Middle East and Africa on markets, feasibility and development strategy. This report looks at one buyer that appears in almost every African housing market and in almost no housing statistic: the citizen who lives abroad and buys at home.

It uses public sources current in 2026: central banks, statistics offices, World Bank data, housing ministries, regulators, listed companies, industry bodies and the press. Every figure is referenced in the exhibit sources and the notes.

Where we combine published figures into a new one, such as a remittance-to-FDI multiple or a dollar price series, the calculation is labelled Heirstone analysis and its inputs are shown. Local-currency amounts carry a US dollar equivalent at the World Bank annual average exchange rate for the year stated. Asking prices are not transaction prices, and we say which is which.

The twelve markets in the Heirstone Diaspora Housing Monitor: Egypt, Morocco, Tunisia, Algeria, Nigeria, Ghana, Senegal, Côte d'Ivoire, Cabo Verde, Kenya, Ethiopia and Zimbabwe.

THE ARGUMENT IN
BRIEF

A strong buyer, a weak occupier

In most of the markets we studied, remittances bring in more hard currency than foreign direct investment. Africans abroad spend part of it on homes, buying when the local currency is cheap and often for a home they occupy only on visits. That makes the diaspora a reliable source of sales and dollars, and a poor source of lived-in housing. The products that work are priced in hard currency, paid in instalments, verifiable from abroad and managed while the owner is away.

WHAT WE FOUND

Africans abroad are large buyers of homes in Africa, and statistics barely record them

Housing plans in Africa are usually written for a resident household that earns locally and lives in the home it buys. The diaspora buyer earns in dollars, euros or riyals, times its purchase to the currency and often leaves the home closed between visits.

1 Remittances outweigh foreign investment in most diaspora markets. In Sub-Saharan Africa they still trail aid.

From 2015 to 2024 Nigeria received 9.9 times as much in remittances as in net foreign direct investment, Kenya 5.3 times and Morocco 4.0 times. The claim that remittances exceed aid and investment combined holds for the Middle East and North Africa; in Sub-Saharan Africa, net aid of US\$64.8bn exceeded recorded remittances of US\$52.2bn in 2023.

2 No registry measures the diaspora share of home sales.

The firmest numbers are programme counts: Moroccans abroad were 24% of the 75,760 recipients of Morocco's direct housing aid by November 2025, and one Nairobi scheme reports 25% diaspora buyers. The 70 to 80% of Lagos and Abuja developer sales cited by an estate firm cannot be verified, and household surveys that measure different things give answers from 2% to 57%.

3 In devaluing markets the diaspora buys at a discount, which starts to close within about a year.

New Cairo apartment asking prices rose 89% in pounds between May 2021 and March 2024, which gave buyers earning in dollars a 38% discount. By June 2025 the dollar price had recovered 20% from its low, and buyers abroad still paid about a quarter less than in May 2021. Over 18 years Nairobi suburban house prices doubled in shillings and rose about 9% in dollars.

4 A large part of what the diaspora builds stands empty.

Egypt's census is the only one we found in our sample that links closed homes to owners abroad: 1.159 million in 2017, about one for every eight Egyptians abroad. Morocco's urban secondary homes rose from 9.3% to 15.5% of the stock between 2014 and 2024, and to about a quarter in the Oriental region. In Cabo Verde 29% of dwellings were seasonal or vacant in 2021.

5 States now sell to their diaspora in dollars, or bank its savings.

Egypt's dollar-priced plots for citizens abroad have generated between US\$7.3bn and US\$10bn since 2012, depending on the source; Nigeria's 2017 diaspora bond raised US\$300m. Moroccans abroad hold MAD 228bn (about US\$24bn) of deposits at home, equal to 89% of the country's housing loans.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments should count the diaspora home, as Egypt's census does, and treat closed homes as supply. Letting or managing part of the 1.159 million would add usable housing alongside new dollar launches.

Developers should price in hard currency or index to it, sell in instalments, report progress to buyers abroad and offer management for the months the owner is away.

Lenders and investors should underwrite the exchange rate and the visit pattern as well as the rent.

12

markets in the Heirstone Diaspora Housing Monitor, from Egypt and Morocco to Senegal, Kenya and Cabo Verde

4

types of diaspora buyer in the Heirstone typology, each needing a different product

CHAPTER 1

01

Bigger than
FDI, smaller
than aid

Recorded remittances to African countries reached new highs in 2024 and 2025. They are a hard-currency housing budget that sits outside most investment statistics.

US\$57.2bn

received by Sub-Saharan Africa in 2024, 36% more than in 2015 (World Bank)

Egyptians abroad sent home a record US\$36.5bn in the fiscal year to June 2025, according to the Central Bank of Egypt, 66% more than a year earlier. On World Bank figures for calendar 2024, Egypt received US\$29.6bn, Nigeria US\$22.1bn and Morocco US\$12.5bn. Those three account for 69% of the remittances received by the twelve markets we track (Exhibit 1).

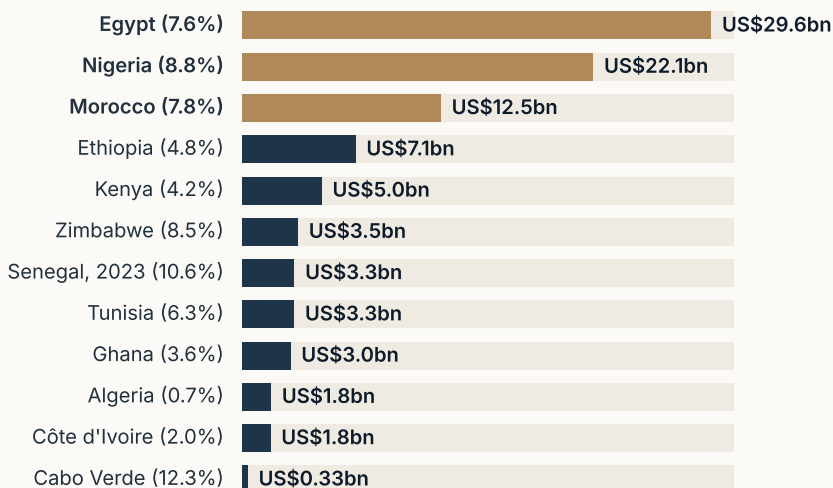
Size relative to the economy matters more for housing. Remittances equalled 10.6% of Senegal's GDP in 2023 and 12.3% of Cabo Verde's in 2024. Nigeria's ratio jumped to 8.8% in 2024 from 4.0% a year earlier, mostly because the naira's fall shrank GDP in dollars; dollar remittances rose 13%.

This money reaches households in hard currency, and the people who send it often want a home of their own at the other end. Developers from Cairo to Accra now sell at fairs in London, Paris, Philadelphia, Riyadh and Dubai.

EXHIBIT 1

Egypt, Nigeria and Morocco account for 69% of the remittances received by the twelve markets we track

Personal remittances received, 2024, US\$bn; remittances as a share of GDP in brackets (Senegal 2023)



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators (BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT and BX.TRF.PWKR.DT.GD.ZS), accessed 2026. Ethiopia's 2024 figure follows the move to a market-determined exchange rate and is not comparable with earlier years. Heirstone analysis for the share.

Per person the sums are large. On the Ministry of Emigration's estimate of about 14 million Egyptians abroad, the 2024/25 record works out at about US\$2,600 per emigrant. The World Bank's 2011 study of African migration put remittances at nearly US\$40bn across about 30 million Africans abroad in 2010, about US\$1,300 each.

A single month of Egyptian remittances, US\$3.6bn in June 2025, was twice Morocco's net FDI for all of 2024.

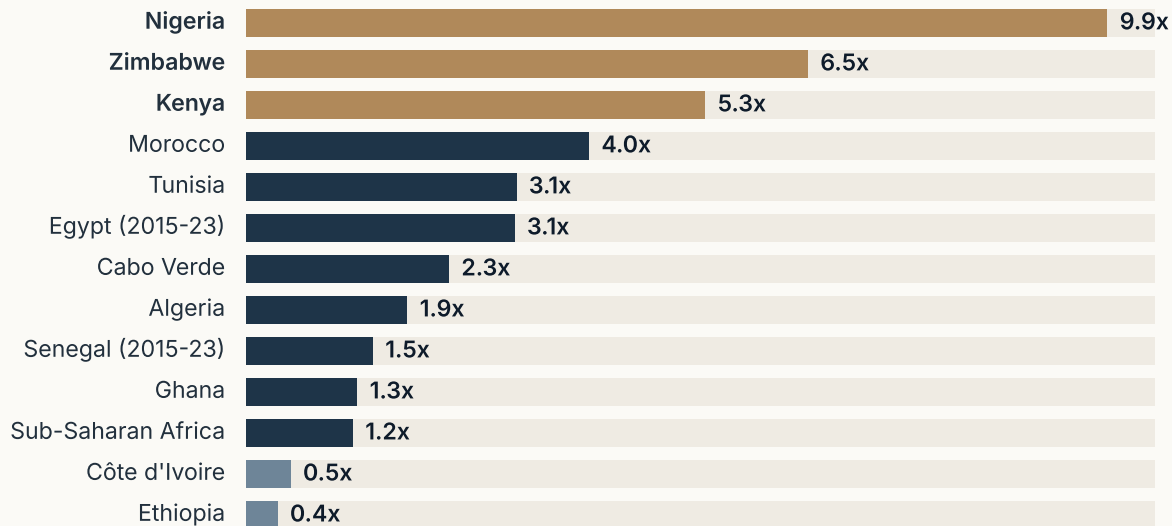
REMITTANCES AGAINST INVESTMENT

Over ten years, Nigeria's diaspora sent home almost ten times what foreign companies invested

EXHIBIT 2

Remittances exceeded net FDI in ten of the twelve markets over 2015 to 2024

Cumulative personal remittances received divided by cumulative net FDI inflows, 2015 to 2024, multiple (Egypt and Senegal 2015 to 2023)



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators (BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT; BX.KLT.DINV.CD.WD), accessed 2026. Heirstone analysis. Egypt including 2024, the year of the Ras El Hekma transaction: 2.1x. Ethiopia's recorded remittances were small until its 2024 float.

The usual comparison sets one year's remittances against one year's FDI. We summed both over ten years, which smooths out single large deals. Nigeria received US\$209bn in remittances between 2015 and 2024 and US\$21bn of net FDI. Kenya's multiple is 5.3 and Morocco's 4.0. Egypt's was 3.1 to 2023; including 2024, the year of the Ras El Hekma transaction, when net FDI of US\$46.6bn exceeded remittances for the only time in the decade, it falls to 2.1.

The francophone exceptions matter for investors. Côte d'Ivoire received about twice as much FDI as remittances, and Senegal's multiple is only 1.5 although remittances are worth a tenth of its GDP. Ethiopia's

ratio is the lowest because its recorded remittances stayed below US\$0.6bn a year from 2017 to 2023, then jumped to US\$7.1bn in 2024.

Net official development assistance to Sub-Saharan Africa was US\$64.8bn in 2023, above the region's recorded remittances of US\$52.2bn and its net FDI of US\$42.5bn. The often-repeated line that remittances exceed aid and FDI combined is true of the Middle East and North Africa, where the World Bank put them at more than twice the sum in 2023. South of the Sahara, aid is still the larger flow, and housing strategies built on the opposite assumption overstate the diaspora's weight.

9.9x

Nigeria's remittances over net FDI, 2015 to 2024 (US\$209bn against US\$21bn)

57x

Comoros: remittances over net FDI in 2023, the highest multiple among the African economies in our data

US\$64.8bn

net aid to Sub-Saharan Africa in 2023, against US\$52.2bn of recorded remittances

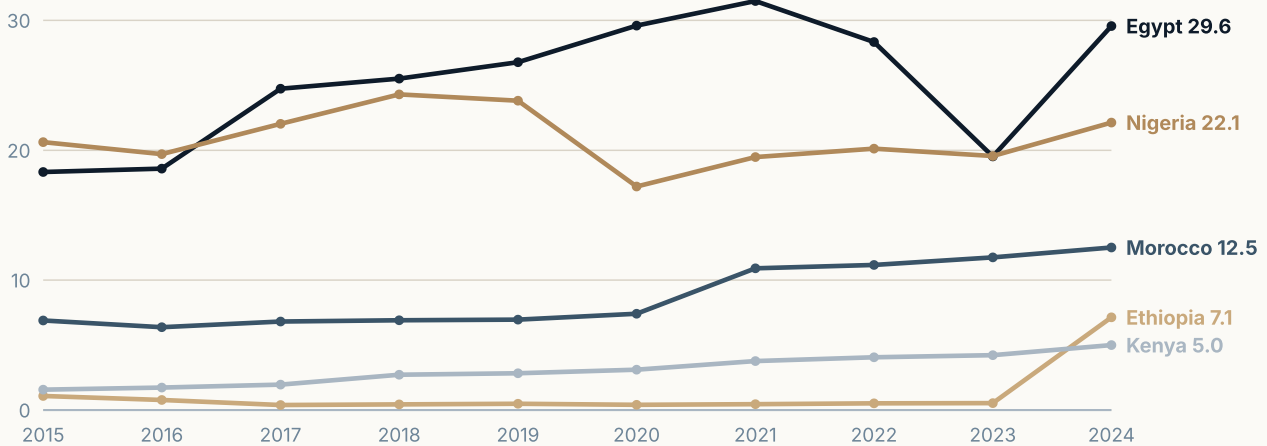
CHANNELS

Part of the recent growth is money moving into official channels when exchange rates are freed

EXHIBIT 3

Recorded remittances jump when an exchange-rate gap closes

Personal remittances received, US\$bn, 2015 to 2024



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators (BX.TRF.PWKR.CD.DT), accessed 2026. Egypt unified its exchange rate in March 2024; Ethiopia moved to a market-determined rate in July 2024.

Recorded remittances follow exchange-rate policy as closely as migration. Egypt's recovered to US\$29.6bn in 2024 after the March 2024 exchange-rate unification, with 16 consecutive months of year-on-year growth, from US\$19.5bn in 2023, when the official and parallel rates had drifted apart. Ethiopia's recorded inflow rose thirteen-fold in 2024, the year it moved to a market-determined rate. In Nigeria, transfers through licensed money transfer operators came to US\$2.33bn in the first half of 2024, according to the central bank, against a World Bank estimate of US\$22.1bn for the whole year.

For property this has a practical consequence. Where official and parallel rates differ, part of the

diaspora's money arrives through channels no statistic records, and so does part of its property buying. Official figures then understate the diaspora's weight before a float and exaggerate how fast it grows afterwards.

Cost also shapes how a deposit is paid. On the France to Morocco corridor, the World Bank's price survey found costs ranging from 1.46% with a digital operator to 45.07% at a savings bank on a US\$200 transfer in the third quarter of 2025. France to Algeria averaged 45.13%, with a single bank surveyed; UK to Nigeria averaged 1.96%. The survey stops at US\$500. There is no public price series for transfers of the size a property deposit needs.

US\$2.33bn

Nigeria's inflows through licensed transfer operators in H1 2024, against a World Bank estimate of US\$22.1bn for 2024

9%

approximate average cost of sending US\$200 to Sub-Saharan Africa in Q1 2025, against 6.4% globally and a 3% target (UN DESA)

1%

US federal excise on cash-funded remittances from January 2026. North America sent 58% of Kenya's 2025 inflows

CHAPTER 2



02

Four ways to buy from abroad

Much diaspora money reaches housing as a plot and a slow build, paid for over years from abroad. Other buyers want a finished flat, a summer house or simply a safe place to save.

No land registry or notary system that we found in the markets studied publishes the share of homes bought by citizens who live abroad. What exists is a patchwork: programme counts from governments, a few project disclosures, household surveys that ask how remittances are spent, and estimates from agents and fair organisers. Exhibit 4 sorts this evidence by strength.

The firmest numbers come from Morocco and Egypt, where the state itself sells or subsidises. Moroccans resident abroad, known as MRE, were 22% of the first 17,000 recipients of the direct housing aid introduced in 2024, 26% of applications by January

2025 and 24% of 75,760 beneficiaries by November 2025. In Egypt, the main tenth phase of the Bait Al Watan plot scheme drew nearly 15,000 bank transfers from Egyptians abroad in 2025.

South of the Sahara the best disclosure is a single scheme. Centum reports that 25% of buyers at its 400-unit Cascadia development in Nairobi are Kenyans abroad and 15% are foreigners. A national figure of 20% of Kenyan property transactions, published without attribution in 2024, and the 70 to 80% of developer sales in Lagos, Abuja and Port Harcourt cited by the estate firm Northcourt cannot be checked.

THE EVIDENCE

Official counts of diaspora buyers exist only where the state sells or subsidises

EXHIBIT 4

Every quantified statement we found on the diaspora's share of buying, from strongest to weakest

Published figures on diaspora purchases, applications or sales, 2012 to 2026

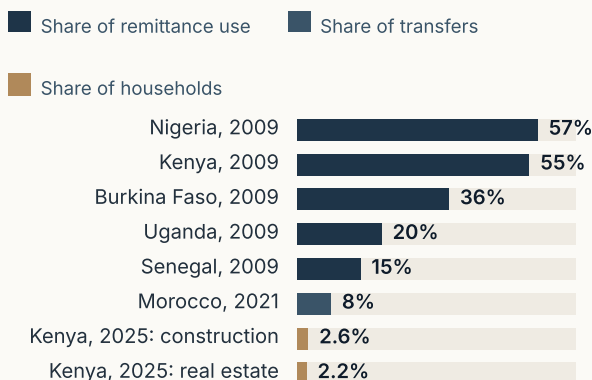
MARKET	WHAT IS MEASURED	DIASPORA FIGURE	WHO SAYS IT	EVIDENCE
Morocco	Recipients of direct housing aid	24% of 75,760	Government spokesman, Nov 2025	Official programme
Morocco	Applications for direct housing aid	26%	Housing Minister, Jan 2025	Official programme
Egypt	Bait Al Watan phase 10 (plots for Egyptians abroad)	c.15,000 transfers; 13,000 plots reserved	Ministry of Housing, Sep 2025	Official programme
Egypt	Sales to non-residents ("property exports")	US\$1.5bn in 2025	Real Estate Development Chamber, Dec 2025	Industry body
Kenya	Buyers at Cascadia, Two Rivers (400 units)	25% diaspora; 15% foreign	Centum, May 2026	Company disclosure
Kenya	All property transactions	20% (10% five years earlier)	Unattributed, The Standard, Aug 2024	Press estimate
Nigeria	Developer sales, Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt	70 to 80%	Northcourt, Dec 2025	Industry claim
Zimbabwe	High-end residential sales	up to 50%	Estate agents, May 2026	Industry claim
Zimbabwe	Harare northern-suburb purchases funded by remittances	up to 60%	ZimProp Expo, Aug 2025	Industry claim
Morocco	Fair sales as a share of one developer's turnover	20 to 30%	Unnamed developer, 2012	Industry claim

Source: Hespress, Bladi.net (Moroccan government statements); Egypt Ministry of Housing; Enterprise; The Star (Kenya); The Standard (Kenya); The Guardian (Nigeria); Al Jazeera; Equity Axis; CCME. Industry claims are reported as made and are not verified.

EXHIBIT 5

Surveys of remittance use give answers from 2% to 57%, on measures that are not comparable

Reported use of remittances for investment in land, housing or business (2009), real estate (Morocco, 2021) or real estate and construction (Kenya, 2025); definitions differ



Source: World Bank Africa Migration Project surveys (2009, published 2011): share of remittance use; Moroccan investment minister (2021): share of MRE transfers; KNBS Remittances Household Survey 2025: share of recipient households, multiple response.

Household surveys give mixed answers. The World Bank's 2009 surveys found land, housing and business took 57% of remittance use in Nigeria and 55% in Kenya. Kenya's 2025 national survey found only 2.2% of recipient households reporting spending on real estate and 2.6% on construction, against 73.1% on food and household goods. The two measure different things, so the fall cannot be read as a trend.

Part of the gap may have a simple explanation. Kenyan developers told The Standard in 2025 that many diaspora buyers now pay them directly by international transfer, instead of sending money to relatives who buy for them. Such payments count as remittances but never reach the households that surveys interview. If that is right, developer sales records will become the better source.

Morocco's investment minister gave a third view: of MAD 100bn sent home by MRE in 2021, MAD 8bn (about US\$0.9bn) went into real estate.

A HEIRSTONE FRAMEWORK

Four diaspora buyers, each needing a different product

The evidence describes several buyers. We group them by what they buy and how they use it. A household can move from one type to another over a working life, and one family can be two types at once. The distinction matters because each type needs its own product and payment plan, and its own answer to the question of who uses the home while the owner is away.

The typology is built from the evidence in this report, and the strength of that evidence varies. The plot builder and the dollar saver are well documented in official data. The summer family is visible in census counts of secondary homes, though not by owner. The remote investor is documented by single projects and lender terms, and is the type developers say is growing fastest.

EXHIBIT 6

The Heirstone typology of diaspora buyers

What each type buys, how it pays and uses the home, the evidence behind it and the product that fits

	TYPE 1 The plot builder	TYPE 2 The summer family	TYPE 3 The remote investor	TYPE 4 The dollar saver
BUYS	Serviced land, then a house built in stages	A second home in the home region or on the coast	A finished apartment or house in the capital, often managed	Deposits, certificates and bonds at home; property later
PAYS WITH	Remittances over many years; dollar-priced plots in Egypt	Savings, local mortgages and, in Morocco, state aid	Developer instalments over 12 to 24 months; dollar mortgages in Ghana	Hard currency converted at home; diaspora bond tranches
USES THE HOME	Rarely, until it is finished	During the annual return	Lets it, or holds it empty	Not yet
STRONGEST EVIDENCE	Ghana: 90% of homes self-provided over 5 to 15 years. Senegal: 61.8% self-built. Egypt: c.15,000 plot transfers in one 2025 phase	Morocco: secondary homes 15.5% of urban stock, about 25% in the Oriental. Cabo Verde: seasonal dwellings up 166.5% in 2010 to 2021	Nairobi's Cascadia: 25% diaspora and 15% foreign buyers. Nairobi suburbs: 7.4% gross yield	Morocco: MRE deposits MAD 222.8bn. Senegal: diaspora tranche in a FCFA 450bn bond issue. Egypt: dollar certificates at 7% and 9%
EFFECT ON THE STOCK	Homes built in stages over years, empty until finished	Seasonal vacancy concentrated in emigrant regions and on the coast	Occupied if a manager finds tenants	Funds residents' mortgages through the banks
PRODUCT THAT FITS	Serviced plots with clean title and staged building packages that can be checked from abroad	Compact homes with a letting or management service for the rest of the year	Completed, managed units with remote reporting and a currency-matched loan	Savings plans linked to a future purchase, or a housing bond
WHERE IT DOMINATES (HEIRSTONE VIEW)	Self-build markets: Ghana, Senegal, Kenya's satellite towns; serviced plots in Egypt's new cities	North Africa and Cabo Verde	Nairobi, Lagos, Accra, Addis Ababa	Markets with stable currencies: Morocco, Senegal

Source: Heirstone analysis drawing on HCP (RGPH 2024), INE Cabo Verde (RGPH 2021), CAPMAS (2017 census), CAHF Housing Finance Yearbook 2024, Egypt Ministry of Housing, Bank Al-Maghrib, Le Soleil, Enterprise, Centum via The Star, HassConsult and Ownkey (Ghana mortgage terms).

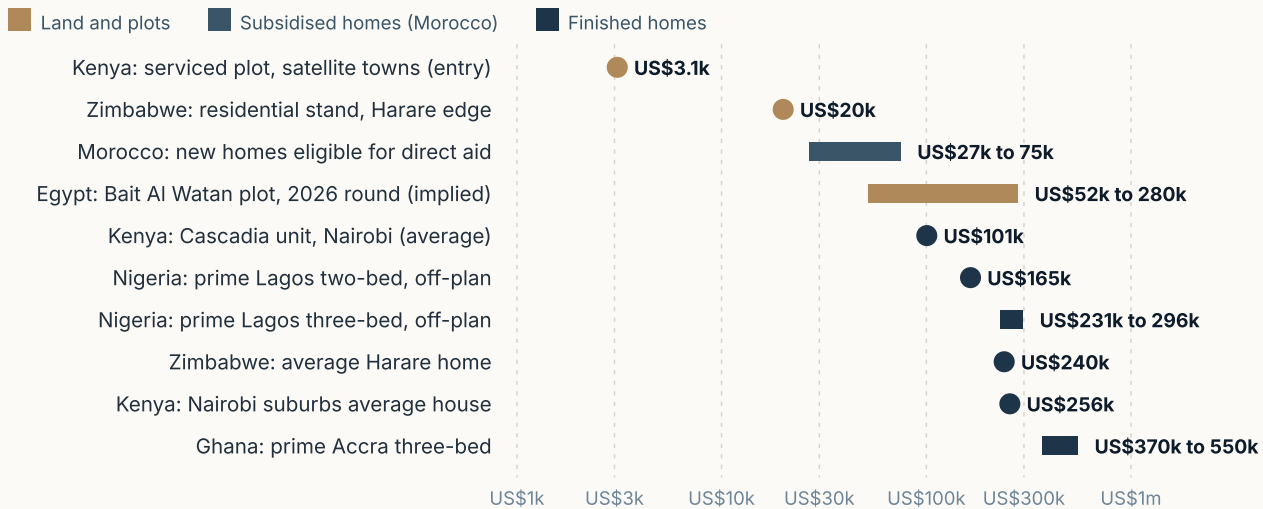
PRICE POINTS

Entry plots near Nairobi cost about a fiftieth of an off-plan flat in prime Lagos

EXHIBIT 7

Diaspora purchases range from US\$3,000 plots to homes above US\$500,000

Prices of products bought by or marketed to diaspora buyers, US\$, log scale; asking or offer prices, 2024 to 2026



Source: The Standard (Kenya, 2024); Equity Axis citing ZimProp Expo (2025); Bladi.net citing Morocco's government (2025) and CAHF (cheapest new unit, MAD 250,000); Egypt Ministry of Housing (2026); Centum via The Star (2026); The Guardian, Nigeria (2025); HassConsult via The Kenya Times (Q2 2026); CAHF (2024). Converted at World Bank 2025 average rates (KES 129.30, MAD 9.35, NGN 1,518.38 per US\$). **Heirstone analysis.**

The spread separates the buyer types. Entry plots in Nairobi's satellite towns are advertised from about US\$3,100 (KSh400,000), according to The Standard, and stands on Harare's edge sell for about US\$20,000 after developers spend US\$8,000 to 12,000 on servicing, according to ZimProp Expo data. Finished homes for remote investors average about US\$100,000 at Nairobi's Cascadia, on our estimate from the development's stated value, and reach US\$370,000 or more in prime Accra.

Egypt shows the depth of diaspora demand for land. The tenth Bait Al Watan plot phase drew about 15,000 transfers in 2025. The first offer of finished units, 5,055 apartments and

villas under Your Home in Egypt, collected about US\$2.5m in its first 48 hours, and the ministry reported high demand, led by Egyptians in Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Bahrain. Plot rounds move larger sums: in one supplementary phase, 1,477 applicants paid US\$142m on reservation, about US\$96,000 each.

The ministry adjusts supply round by round: nearly 3,500 Egyptians abroad made initial reservations in the first week of a supplementary round of about 4,700 plots, and in October 2025 it offered 6,797 plots in 18 cities, 2,141 of them new. In Ghana, fair organisers now advise buyers abroad to buy a finished home, citing the difficulty of acquiring land and supervising a build from a distance.

32x

price of the average Cascadia unit in Nairobi against an entry plot in a satellite town

US\$96,000

paid per applicant on reservation in one Bait Al Watan supplementary phase (US\$142m from 1,477 applicants)

CHAPTER 3

03

The devaluation discount

+89%

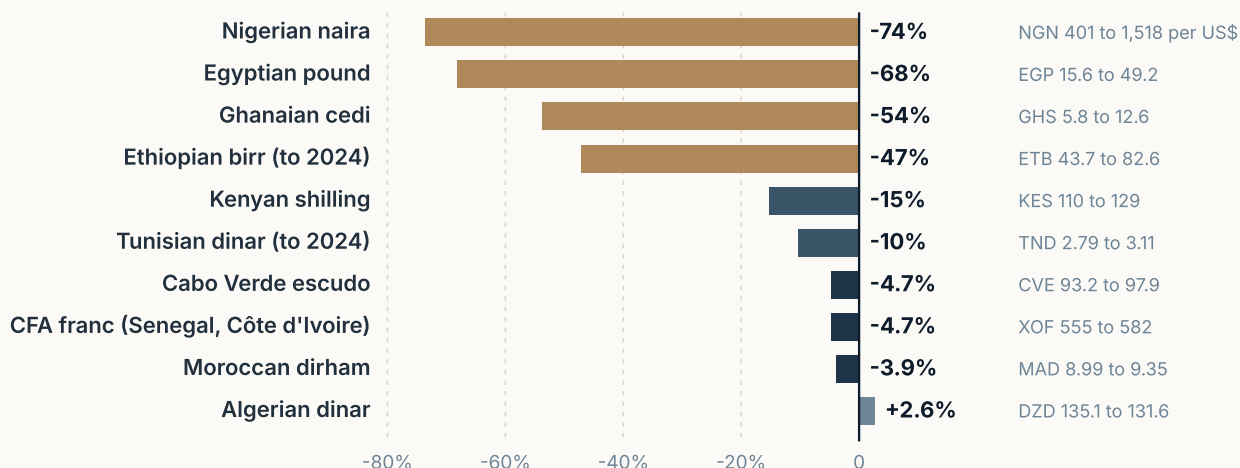
Change in New Cairo apartment asking prices in Egyptian pounds between May 2021 and March 2024. For a buyer paid in dollars, the same homes cost 38% less.

For a buyer paid in dollars, euros or riyals, a devaluation works as a price cut. In Cairo, dollar prices began to recover soon after the 2024 float, and about a third of the discount had closed within fifteen months.

EXHIBIT 8

Four currencies lost about half their dollar value or more after 2021; the dirham, the CFA franc and the escudo barely moved

Change in the US dollar value of the local currency, 2021 to 2025, %, World Bank annual average rates



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators (PA.NUS.FCRF, official exchange rate, annual average), accessed 2026. Ethiopia and Tunisia to 2024. Heirstone analysis.

Between 2021 and 2025 the naira lost 74% of its value against the dollar, the Egyptian pound 68% and the cedi 54%; the pound then held broadly steady after the March 2024 unification. The birr lost 47% by 2024. The Moroccan dirham, the euro-pegged CFA franc and the Cabo Verde escudo moved by less than 5%, and the Tunisian dinar by about 10%.

That divide runs through the rest of this report. Where the currency floats and falls, the diaspora buyer gets a discount and demand comes in waves after each devaluation. Where it is pegged or managed, the diaspora buys at steady prices and keeps its savings at home. Chapter 6 groups the markets on this basis.

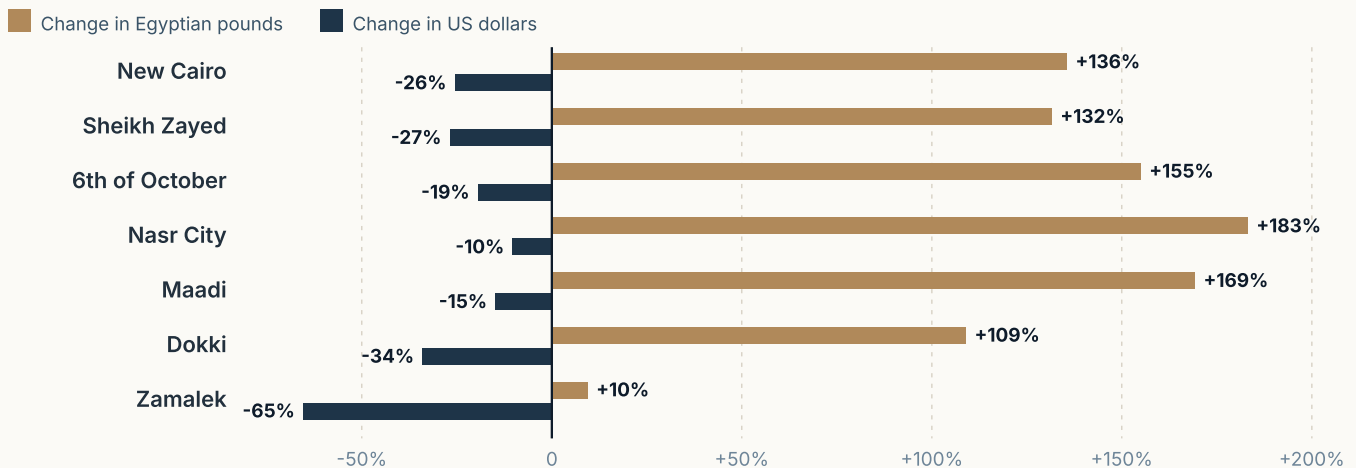
CAIRO IN TWO CURRENCIES

Cairo prices more than doubled in pounds in most districts, giving dollar buyers a discount

EXHIBIT 9

Pound asking prices rose in every Cairo district we tracked, six of seven by more than 100%

Change in average apartment asking price per sq m, May 2021 to June 2025, %

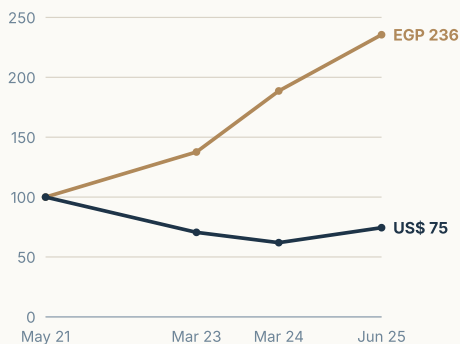


Source: Aqarmap asking prices republished by Global Property Guide (May 2021: EGP 15.67 per US\$; June 2025: EGP 49.66), archive editions 2021 and 2025. Heirstone analysis.

EXHIBIT 10

New Cairo: the dollar price recovered after the float

Asking price per sq m, index May 2021 = 100



Source: As Exhibit 9, with March 2023 and March 2024 editions. Heirstone analysis.

US\$479

New Cairo asking price per sq m in June 2025, 20% above its March 2024 low as dollar prices recovered after the float

Aqarmap's asking-price data, republished by Global Property Guide with the exchange rate used at each date, give a consistent series for seven Cairo districts from May 2021 to June 2025. Asking prices are not transaction prices, but they show what a buyer abroad saw when shopping. In New Cairo the price per square metre went from EGP 10,100 to EGP 19,050 by March 2024, a rise of 89%, while the dollar price fell from US\$643 to US\$398. Zamalek, the established prime district, offered the largest dollar discount: its pound price rose 9.5% to June 2025, so in dollars it cost 65% less than in May 2021.

The discount narrowed within about a year. By June 2025 New Cairo's dollar price was US\$479, 20% above its March 2024 low, as pound prices kept rising and

the currency held steady. A buyer abroad who bought in June 2025 rather than March 2024 gave up about a third of the discount. Diaspora money followed: remittances grew year on year for 16 consecutive months after the float, and the Real Estate Development Chamber put sales to non-residents at US\$1.5bn in 2025, three times the 2024 figure.

Two notes apply. Global Property Guide's December 2025 Cairo figures are 2.6 times its June 2025 figures, far above the 13% national index rise, which suggests a change of data basis; we have not chained them. And property broadly held its value against inflation over 2023 and 2024: the Aqarmap index rose 6.1% in real terms in 2023 and eased 4.8% in 2024, about 1% higher over the two years.

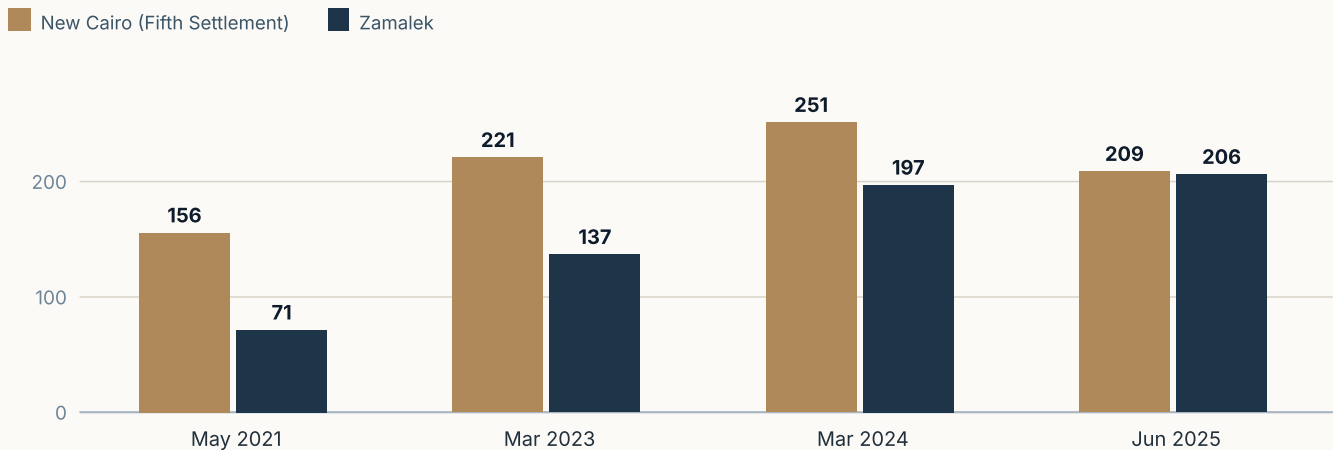
PURCHASING POWER

What US\$100,000 buys, and what the home is worth in dollars later

EXHIBIT 11

A US\$100,000 budget bought 62% more space in New Cairo in March 2024 than in May 2021

Apartment floor area that US\$100,000 would buy at average asking prices, sq m



Source: Aqarmap asking prices via Global Property Guide (2021, 2023, 2024 and 2025 editions), at the exchange rate stated by the source for each date. Heirstone analysis.

Over longer periods the discount shows up as weak returns in dollars. HassConsult's index of Nairobi suburban house asking prices stood at 2.09 times its December 2007 level in the second quarter of 2026, measured in shillings. Converted at World Bank annual average rates for 2007 and 2025, that is about 1.09 times in dollars, a gain of about 9% in 18 years. Satellite towns did better, at about 1.61 times. A buyer who funded a Nairobi suburban house in dollars in 2007 has earned most of the return from rent; gross yields there were 7.4% in mid-2026.

Lagos has no published price index we could use, so we ran a test. A Lekki four-bedroom apartment was advertised at NGN 69.3m (US\$180,059) in September 2020. At the 2025 average rate the same naira price is worth about

US\$45,600. To hold its dollar value it would need to ask about NGN 273m. Any naira price below that is a dollar discount for a buyer abroad.

The same arithmetic erodes local-currency products aimed at the diaspora. Nigeria's Federal Mortgage Bank launched a diaspora mortgage in London in August 2026, lending up to NGN 100m at 9% over ten years. That cap was worth about US\$327,000 at 2017 rates and about US\$66,000 at 2025 rates, roughly 40% of the NGN 250m asked for an off-plan two-bedroom in prime Lagos, according to The Guardian (Nigeria).

One warning for anyone building such series: one published Nairobi dollar price history converts both its start and end dates at the same exchange rate, and so ignores the shilling's fall.

1.09x

Nairobi suburban house prices in dollars, Q2 2026 against December 2007; 2.09x in shillings

NGN 273m

asking price a 2020 Lekki four-bedroom would need in 2025 to hold its US\$180,059 value

US\$66,000

value of Nigeria's NGN 100m diaspora mortgage cap at 2025 rates

CHAPTER 4

04

Closed because the family is abroad

Egypt's census is the only one we found among our twelve markets with a category for homes closed because the household lives abroad: 1.159 million units in 2017.

Housing statistics in Africa usually count a shortage. Censuses in four diaspora-heavy countries also count homes that are built and not lived in, and in three of them part of that stock can be linked to absent or seasonal owners.

Egypt's 2017 census is unusual in recording why homes are not occupied. It counted 8.996 million empty units, 20.9% of all residential units, of which 4.334 million were still unfinished; a further 2.887 million were closed because the family owns another home, and 1.159 million because the household lives abroad. That last line is the most direct measure of diaspora-owned idle housing we found anywhere in Africa: about one closed home for every eight Egyptians counted abroad.

Morocco's 2024 census and Cabo Verde's 2021 census do not record why a home is empty, but they separate secondary and seasonal homes from vacant ones, and their geography points to emigrants. Ghana's 2021 census records vacancy without reasons. Nigeria, Kenya, Senegal and Ethiopia publish no vacancy measure that we could find.

This chapter treats the diaspora home as what it often is: an asset used during the annual visit and closed for the rest of the year. That matters for anyone planning housing supply, utilities or retail in emigrant regions and on the coast, where many of the homes counted are occupied for only part of the year.

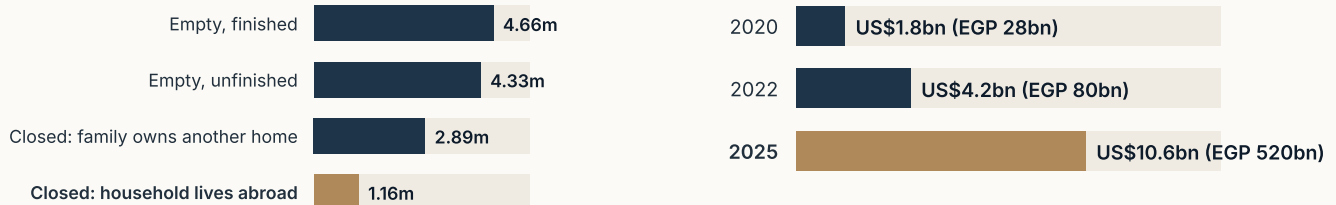
EGYPT

Only Egypt's census, of those we reviewed, counts homes closed by owners abroad

EXHIBIT 12

Egypt's census records why homes are closed; coastal sales rose nearly six-fold in dollars

Left: idle residential units by reason, 2017, millions. Right: North Coast developer sales, US\$bn at World Bank annual average rates (EGP in brackets)



Source: CAPMAS, 2017 census, as reported by Parlmany, Amwal Al Ghad and Egypt Independent (September and October 2017). CAPMAS headline totals differ (12.5 million and 12.8 million) from the sum of the published components (13.0 million). The Board Consulting, as summarised by Spill News (2026), converted at EGP 15.76, 19.16 and 49.23 per US\$ (World Bank). **Heirstone analysis.**

The highest vacancy rates in the 2017 census were in the coastal resort governorates, where homes fill in summer: Matrouh, which contains the North Coast resorts, recorded 46.9%. These shares mix domestic second homes with diaspora homes, and the census does not separate them. Matrouh expected about 6 million summer visitors in 2023, according to the governorate, and the head of the Tourism Syndicate said in 2024 that most North Coast and Alamein resorts are fully occupied in summer.

The coast is now one of Egypt's main property markets. The Board Consulting, as summarised by Spill News, puts 2025 developer sales there at about EGP 520bn (about US\$10.6bn at the 2025 average rate), up from EGP 28bn in 2020, and counts about 245,000 residential units planned in more than 70 projects; in 2024-25 the coast took about a third of national gated-community sales. The state is planning for year-round use: Alamein International University is operating, two more universities are under development, and the head of

New Alamein's city authority describes it as a city, not a seasonal resort.

The state's dollar offers add new supply for Egyptians abroad, starting with 5,055 finished units in the first Your Home in Egypt phase. The homes already closed by households abroad are a second pool: the 1.159 million equal about 2.9 years of Egypt's estimated housing need of 400,000 units a year. An IOM study found that 69% of the Egyptians abroad it interviewed visit Egypt at least once a year, so a letting or management service would let owners keep the home for their visits and earn from it in between. Cairo's average gross rental yield of 9.9% gives them a reason to take part.

Egypt's 2017 census counted 1.159 million homes closed because the household lives abroad, a stock that managed letting could bring into use alongside the state's new dollar offers.

1 in 8

one home closed by a household abroad for every eight Egyptians counted abroad in the 2017 census

6m

summer visitors expected in 2023 in Matrouh, the governorate of the North Coast resorts (governorate figure)

9.9%

average gross rental yield in Cairo, Q2 2026: an income for owners abroad who let between visits (Global Property Guide)

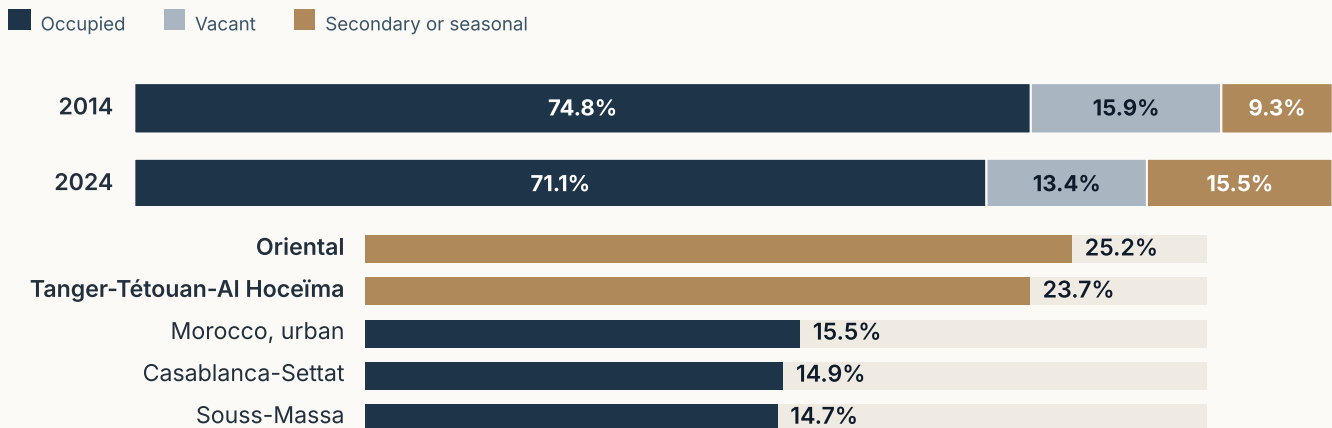
MOROCCO

Secondary homes absorbed the equivalent of a third of Morocco's urban housing growth in ten years

EXHIBIT 13

Morocco's secondary and seasonal homes rose to 15.5% of urban stock, and to about a quarter in two emigrant regions

Top: urban dwellings by occupancy, 2014 and 2024, %. Bottom: secondary and seasonal dwellings as a share of each region's urban stock, 2024, %



Source: HCP, Parc logement urbain au Maroc selon les résultats du RGPH 2024 (December 2025). Regional shares are Heirstone analysis: each region's published share of national secondary stock multiplied by 1.29 million, divided by its urban stock.

Morocco's urban housing stock grew from 6.2 million units in 2014 to 8.34 million in 2024. Over the same decade secondary and seasonal dwellings rose from 9.3% to 15.5% of the stock, from about 0.58 million to 1.29 million; in 2004 they were 4.7%. The increase of about 713,000 equals a third of all urban stock growth and 3.9 times the fall in the HCP's urban housing deficit, which dropped from 519,396 units to 334,221.

The census is silent on ownership. The location of these homes points to emigrants. The Oriental region, around Oujda and Nador, holds 11.7% of the country's urban secondary homes against 6.2% of occupied ones; by our calculation about a quarter of its urban

dwellings are secondary. Tanger-Tétouan-Al Hoceïma holds 20.4% of the national secondary stock, about 24% of its own. Both regions include parts of the Rif, the origin of about 70% of the 400,000 Moroccan nationals in the Netherlands (CCME, 2012). The census does not separate emigrants' homes from other second homes, so the attribution is partial.

Money follows the same calendar. Office des Changes figures imply MRE transfers of about MAD 14.4bn (US\$1.5bn) in August 2026, the month of the summer return, against an average of MAD 10.7bn a month from January to July. One large Moroccan developer said in 2012 that 80 to 90% of MRE demand in the economic and social segment was for second homes.

713,000

increase in Morocco's urban secondary and seasonal homes, 2014 to 2024

1.35x

MRE transfers in August 2026 against the January to July monthly average

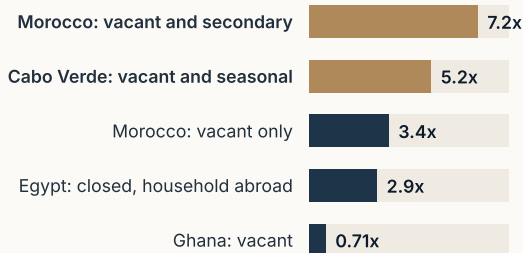
ACROSS THE REGION

Where censuses look, idle stock rivals or exceeds the official shortage

EXHIBIT 14

Morocco and Cabo Verde have five to seven idle homes for every unit of official shortage

Idle dwellings divided by the official deficit or annual need, multiple

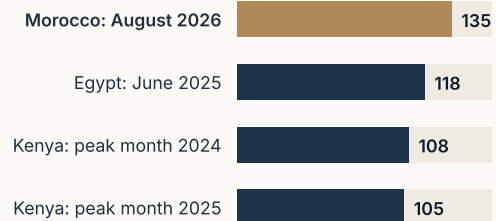


Source: HCP (2024); INE Cabo Verde (2021) and CAHF (2024); CAPMAS (2017) and CAHF; Ghana Statistical Service (2021). Definitions of deficit differ by country. Heirstone analysis.

EXHIBIT 15

Morocco's transfers peak with the summer return; Kenya's barely move

Remittances in the peak month, index: average month = 100 (Morocco: January to July average)



Source: Office des Changes via Hespress (2026); Central Bank of Egypt via Enterprise (2025); Central Bank of Kenya monthly data (2024, 2025). Heirstone analysis.

Cabo Verde is the extreme case in our data. Its 2021 census counted 200,979 dwellings, of which 19,683 were for seasonal use and 38,524 were vacant: 29% of the stock was not a main residence. Between 2010 and 2021 seasonal dwellings rose 166.5% and vacant ones 78.8%, against 25.4% for main residences, so about half of all dwellings added were seasonal or vacant.

Remittances equal about 12% of GDP, and CAHF reports that most households pay for housing from their own savings, informal savings groups and remittances. Sal and Boa Vista, the tourist islands, show the widest gaps between dwellings and households, so tourism explains part of the pattern.

Ghana's 2021 census found 12.7% of dwellings vacant and 14.6% in Greater Accra, about 1.27 million units, equal to 71% of the official deficit of 1.8 million. The census does not ask why a home is empty. The minister at the time attributed

empty houses to prices above what people can pay; diaspora ownership was not tested.

Elsewhere the measure is missing. Nigeria has held no census since 2006. In Abuja the city administration has identified about 600 unoccupied buildings in high-end districts, which on the evidence available cannot be attributed to the diaspora. The seasonal pattern of remittances is a rough guide to which markets build for the visit: 75% of North Africa's emigrants live outside Africa, mainly in Europe and the Gulf, while 64% of Sub-Saharan Africa's live in another Sub-Saharan country (UN DESA, 2024).

Exhibit 15 shows the difference in timing. Morocco's August transfers ran 35% above the average of the seven months before. Kenya's busiest month in 2025 was only 5% above the year's average, and its monthly flows show no summer peak.

29%

of Cabo Verde's dwellings were seasonal or vacant in 2021

71%

Ghana's vacant dwellings as a share of its official housing deficit (2021)

CHAPTER 5

05

Selling to citizens abroad

Governments now treat the diaspora as a customer as well as a source of remittances. Egypt offers it land and homes priced in dollars; Morocco banks its savings and subsidises its purchases; Senegal sells it bonds.

Egypt's Bait Al Watan scheme has offered serviced plots to Egyptians abroad since 2012, priced and paid in dollars. In 2017 New Cairo plots were priced at US\$650 per square metre, up from US\$550 a year earlier, with 25% down, five years of instalments and a 15% discount for cash. The 2026 round asks deposits of about US\$13,000 to 70,000, which at the usual 25% imply plot prices of US\$52,000 to 280,000. Plots of 400 to 800 square metres have been offered in 24 cities, about 55% of them in the new cities around Cairo.

How much the scheme has generated depends on the source. The housing minister put the figure at nearly US\$7.3bn in 2024, as quoted by Mada Masr; AGBI reported about US\$10bn from roughly 25,000 plots by early 2025. We show the range. In October 2025 the government set a target of up to US\$7bn over four years from more than 18,000 further plots, with instalments running to 2029. That is about US\$1.75bn a year, and in total more than 20 times Nigeria's 2017 diaspora bond.

Since 2025 the ministry has added finished homes, all payable in dollars from abroad: 5,055 apartments, duplexes and villas in February, a phase linked to the North Coast in August and 785 luxury units in October, including at New Alamein and Marina Alamein.



A sales stand at a property fair. Egyptian developers now hold regular fairs in Riyadh, Jeddah, Dubai and Doha.

US\$7.3-10bn

generated by Bait Al Watan plot sales to Egyptians abroad since 2012; sources differ

US\$7bn

target from 18,000 more plots over four years, announced October 2025

US\$1.5bn

Egypt's property sales to non-residents in 2025, three times 2024 (Real Estate Development Chamber)

THREE WAYS STATES COURT THEIR DIASPORA

Egypt offers land and homes

Land and homes priced and paid in dollars from abroad: plot sales of US\$7.3bn to US\$10bn since 2012, depending on the source.

Morocco banks and subsidises

MRE deposits of MAD 228bn equal 89% of housing loans; MRE take 24% of direct housing aid.

Senegal borrows

A 2025 savings bond with a diaspora tranche raised FCFA 450bn (about US\$773m) across the whole issue; 20,000 homes are earmarked for the diaspora.

EGYPT

Egypt widened its dollar offer to citizens abroad in 2025, from serviced plots to finished homes

EXHIBIT 16

Fourteen years of selling land and homes to Egyptians abroad in dollars

State offers to Egyptians abroad, with supply, uptake and terms where published

DATE	OFFER	SUPPLY	UPTAKE OR MONEY RAISED	TERMS
Jan 2017	Bait Al Watan round	5,000 plots	US\$1.8bn expected	New Cairo US\$650 per sq m; 25% down; five-year instalments
c.2020-21	Bait Al Watan, 8th supplementary phase	n/p	1,477 applicants paid US\$142m	Reservation and 25% in US\$; balance in pounds pegged to US\$
2012-2024	Phases 1 to 9 combined	c.25,000 plots	US\$7.3bn (minister, 2024) to US\$10bn (AGBI, early 2025)	
Jan-Sep 2025	Phase 10, main	2,974 plots at launch, then expanded	c.15,000 transfers; 13,000 plots reserved	Allocation in order of transfers received
Feb 2025	Your Home in Egypt, phase 1	5,055 units in 13 projects	c.US\$2.5m in 48 hours	All payments in US\$; apartments 79 to 344 sq m
Aug 2025	Bait Al Watan units, North Coast-linked	Apartments 100 to 250 sq m; villas; plots	n/p	US\$ transfers only; 5 to 7-year instalments on some
Sep-Oct 2025	Phase 10, supplementary and October offer	c.4,700, then 6,797 plots	c.3,500 initial reservations in the first week	18 cities; 2,141 new plots in October
Oct 2025	Your Home in Egypt, phase 2	785 luxury units	n/p	3 to 10% expatriate discounts; up to 10 years
Apr 2026	Bait Al Watan 2026	3,600 plots	n/p	Deposits US\$13,000 to 70,000

Source: Egypt Ministry of Housing real estate portal (2025-2026); Invest-Gate (2017; c.2021); Egypt Today (2025); AGBI (October 2025); Mada Masr (December 2025). n/p: not published.

Serviced plots are the programme's strongest product. The main 2025 plot phase drew about 15,000 transfers and was expanded from the 2,974 plots first offered; with its supplementary round, phase 10 offered nearly 18,000 plots, against about 25,000 in the nine phases before it. Handover of plots to buyers began in New Obour in June 2025 and in New Cairo in November 2025. Payment periods have lengthened, from five years in 2017 to up to ten years on units in 2025. In earlier rounds, after the reservation and 25% were paid in dollars, the balance was due in pounds at a value pegged to the dollar, so the price stayed fixed in dollars and the state collected hard currency up front.

Private developers sell to the same buyers. Egyptian developers hold

regular fairs in Riyadh, Jeddah, Dubai and Doha, where visitors include Gulf nationals as well as Egyptians resident there; one organiser held its 27th edition in Riyadh in 2025, and exhibitors at a Doha fair advertised zero-down plans over 10 to 15 years, according to Invest-Gate. Saudi Arabia's 2022 census counted 1,471,382 Egyptians, the largest Egyptian community abroad. The Real Estate Development Chamber put national property sales to non-residents at about US\$1.5bn in 2025, three times the 2024 figure.

Fairs are a busy channel: the organiser of one Dubai fair reported more than 5,800 visitors and, on its own definitions, not comparable with the national figure, about AED 2.2bn (about US\$599m) of confirmed sales at its 2025 edition.

c.18,000

plots offered to Egyptians abroad in Bait Al Watan's tenth phase in 2025, against about 25,000 in the nine phases before it

3.70%

average cost of sending US\$200 from the UAE to Egypt in Q3 2025; 5.15% from Saudi Arabia

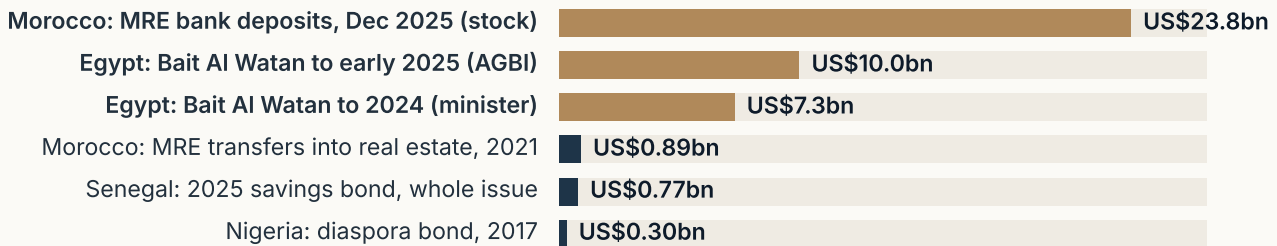
MOROCCO, SENEGAL AND THE REST

A stable currency turns the diaspora into a saver before it becomes a buyer

EXHIBIT 17

Morocco's diaspora deposits and Egypt's dollar plot sales, built up over years, are the largest pools shown

Diaspora money held in, or raised by, domestic institutions, US\$bn; stocks and cumulative or single-year flows as labelled



Source: Bank Al-Maghrib via Bladi.net (2026); AGBI and Mada Masr (2025); Moroccan investment minister via Medias24 (2022); Le Soleil via AllAfrica (2025); ThisDay (2017). MAD converted at 9.35 (2025) and 8.99 (2021), FCFA at 581.93 (2025) per US\$. Senegal: whole issue; the diaspora share is not published. Heirstone analysis.

The dirham lost only 4% against the dollar between 2021 and 2025, so Morocco's diaspora gets no devaluation discount, and it saves at home instead. MRE held MAD 222.8bn (about US\$23.8bn) of deposits at the end of 2025 and MAD 228bn in March 2026: 22.7% of household deposits and 89% of the country's MAD 256.6bn housing-loan book (Bank Al-Maghrib). Only 0.3% of Moroccan bank accounts are in foreign currency, which suggests that almost all of it is held in dirhams. Housing loans grew 2.9% in the year to March 2026, household deposits 8.1%.

The state then subsidises the diaspora as a buyer. The direct housing aid introduced in 2024 pays MAD 100,000 (about US\$10,700) towards homes under MAD 300,000 and MAD 70,000 for homes up to MAD 700,000. About 24% of recipients are MRE, roughly 18,200 households by November 2025 on our calculation. According to a comparison site, banks lend MRE up to 80% at 4.5% to 5.8% and ask for 30% of the deposit in foreign currency.

Senegal, whose CFA franc is pegged to the euro, borrows. Its third public savings bond of 2025 carried a Diaspora Bonds tranche, with tickets from FCFA 10,000 (about US\$17) and coupons of 6.40% to 6.95%. The issue raised over FCFA 450bn against a FCFA 300bn target, with Senegalese in more than 45 countries subscribing; the sources do not split the total between residents and the diaspora. In 2021 Senegal earmarked 20,000 homes of its 100,000-home programme for the diaspora, and SICAP has secured 200 hectares at Sessen for a diaspora city of up to 6,000 homes. Delivery is the constraint: the programme completed 157 units in 2023 against a target of 10,000 (CAHF).

Elsewhere the products are smaller. Nigeria raised US\$300m from a diaspora bond in 2017 and launched a naira diaspora mortgage in 2026. Ethiopia gives foreign nationals of Ethiopian origin property rights under a separate regime. In Ghana, four banks offer dollar mortgages to buyers abroad at 10.5% to 12%, against 22% to 28% for cedi loans, according to a comparison site.

89%

MRE deposits as a share of Morocco's housing-loan book, March 2026

18,200

MRE households receiving Morocco's direct housing aid by November 2025 (24% of 75,760)

157

homes completed in 2023 by Senegal's 100,000-home programme, which earmarks 20,000 for the diaspora

CHAPTER 6

06

The Heirstone
Diaspora Housing
Monitor

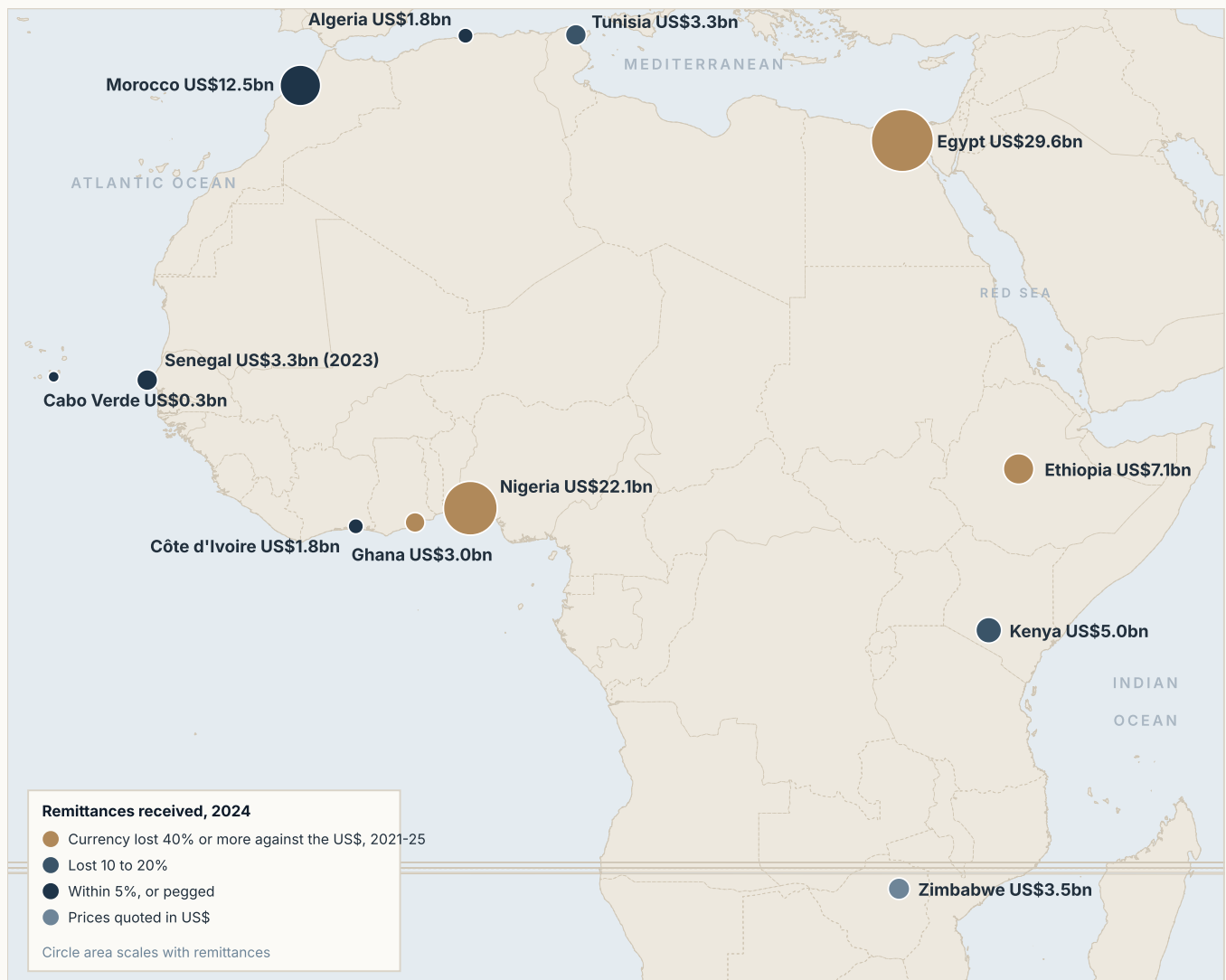
We compiled the same indicators for twelve markets across North Africa and Sub-Saharan Africa, anglophone, francophone and lusophone: the size of diaspora money, its weight against foreign investment, the stability of the currency it buys in, the census evidence of idle stock and the state's diaspora housing channel.

The pages that follow set out the Monitor, a market map that groups the twelve into four types, and notes on each market.

EXHIBIT 18

Diaspora money is concentrated on the Mediterranean coast and in Nigeria

Personal remittances received, 2024 (Senegal 2023), by country, plotted at the main city; colour shows the currency's change against the US dollar, 2021 to 2025



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators, accessed 2026; Natural Earth. Positions mark the main city, not the location of flows. Zimbabwe uses several currencies and most property prices there are quoted in US dollars. Heirstone analysis.

THE MONITOR

Twelve markets on one page

Remittances and % of GDP: World Bank, 2024. Remittances divided by net FDI: cumulative 2015 to 2024; Egypt to 2023 (in brackets, including 2024). Currency: change in the US dollar value of the local currency, World Bank annual averages. *Senegal remittances 2023 and multiple 2015 to 2023; Tunisia and Ethiopia currency to 2024. n/f: no measure or programme found in the sources reviewed. Group: see the market map on the next page.

EXHIBIT 19

The Heirstone Diaspora Housing Monitor 2026

MARKET	REMIT. 2024, US\$BN	% OF GDP	REMIT. / NET FDI, 2015-24	CURRENCY VS US\$, 2021-25	CENSUS IDLE-STOCK SIGNAL	STATE OR BANK DIASPORA HOUSING CHANNEL	MARKET-MAP GROUP
NORTH AFRICA							
Egypt	29.6	7.6	3.1x (2.1x)	-68%	1.159m units closed, household abroad (2017); the only census count we found tied to owners abroad	US\$-priced plots and units (Bait Al Watan; Your Home in Egypt)	Discount, high weight
Morocco	12.5	7.8	4.0x	-4%	Urban secondary homes 15.5% (2024); about 25% in the Oriental	Direct housing aid, 24% to MRE; MRE deposits MAD 228bn	Savings, high weight
Tunisia	3.3	6.3	3.1x	-10%*	n/f	n/f	Savings, high weight
Algeria	1.8	0.7	1.9x	+3%	n/f	n/f	Stable, low recorded weight
WEST AFRICA							
Nigeria	22.1	8.8	9.9x	-74%	No census since 2006	FHA Diaspora City (17,000 units planned); naira diaspora mortgage	Discount, high weight
Ghana	3.0	3.6	1.3x	-54%	12.7% vacant (2021), reasons not recorded	n/f; US\$ mortgages at four banks	Discount, lower weight
Senegal	3.3*	10.6*	1.5x*	-5%	n/f	20,000-home diaspora quota; diaspora bond tranche	Savings, high weight
Côte d'Ivoire	1.8	2.0	0.5x	-5%	n/f	n/f	Stable, low weight
Cabo Verde	0.33	12.3	2.3x	-5%	29.0% seasonal or vacant (2021)	n/f	Savings, high weight
EAST AND SOUTHERN AFRICA							
Kenya	5.0	4.2	5.3x	-15%	n/f	n/f; bank diaspora mortgages (KES, USD, GBP)	Stable, low weight
Ethiopia	7.1	4.8	0.4x	-47%*	No census since 2007	Property rights for Ethiopian-origin foreigners; FX diaspora accounts	Discount, lower weight
Zimbabwe	3.5	8.5	6.5x	US\$ prices	n/f	Lenders' diaspora mortgage products (CAHF)	Dollar-priced

Source: World Bank WDI (remittances, GDP ratios, net FDI, exchange rates), accessed 2026; CAPMAS (2017); HCP (2024); Ghana Statistical Service (2021); INE Cabo Verde (2021); Egypt Ministry of Housing; Bladi.net and Le Matin citing Moroccan government and Bank Al-Maghrib; Dakaractu and Le Soleil (Senegal); The Guardian and Ecofin (Nigeria); KCB; Ownkey (Ghana); Dablo Law Firm and Wikipedia (Ethiopia); CAHF (2024). **Heirstone analysis.**

Diaspora money is large almost everywhere

Remittances exceed net FDI over ten years in ten of the twelve markets. Côte d'Ivoire and Ethiopia are the exceptions, and Ethiopia's recorded flows only became comparable in 2024.

Idle stock is measured in only four

Egypt, Morocco, Ghana and Cabo Verde publish census measures of vacant, closed or seasonal homes. Only Egypt ties a count to owners abroad. Elsewhere the diaspora's effect on vacancy cannot be checked.

States court the diaspora in different ways

Egypt offers state land and homes priced in dollars; Morocco subsidises and banks diaspora deposits; Senegal sells bonds and earmarks homes; Nigeria and Ghana rely mostly on developers and lenders.

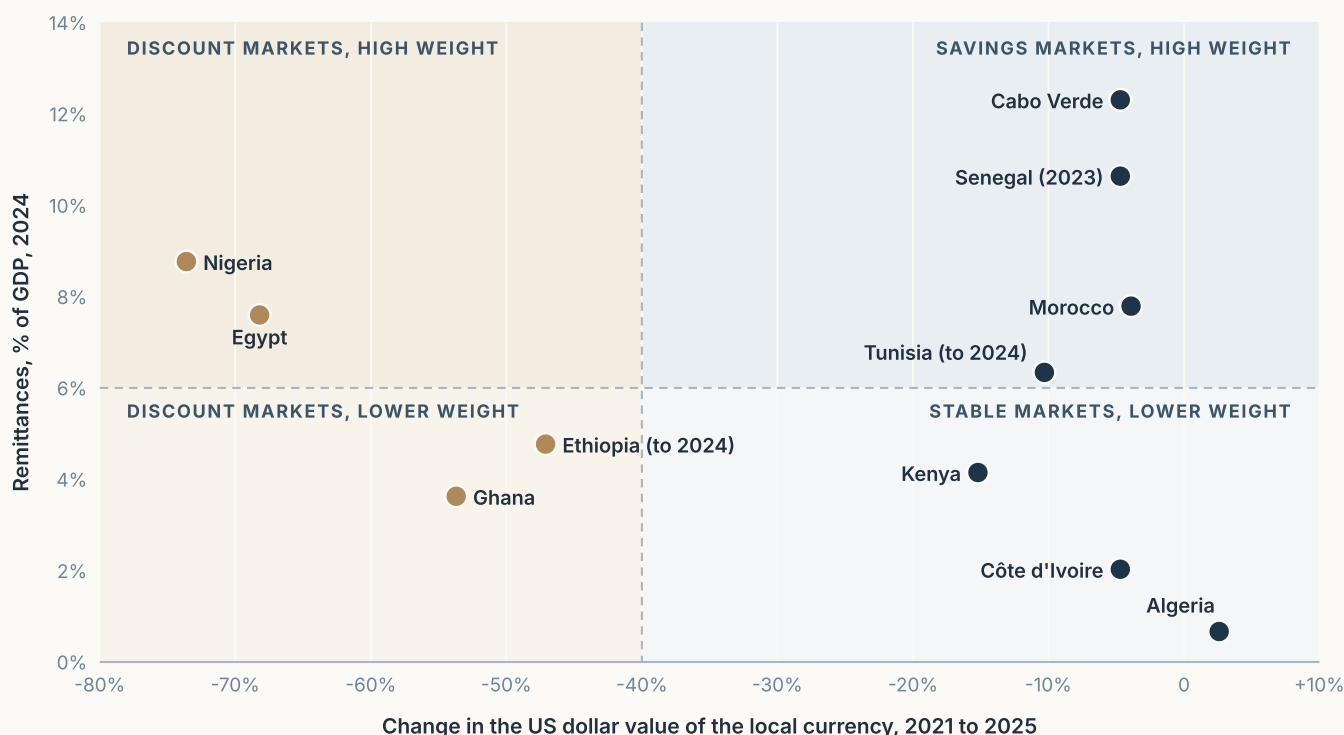
A HEIRSTONE FRAMEWORK

The diaspora market map: two questions sort the twelve markets into four groups

EXHIBIT 20

Currency stability and diaspora weight place the markets in four groups

Remittances as % of GDP (2024; Senegal 2023) against the change in the US dollar value of the local currency (2021 to 2025; Ethiopia and Tunisia to 2024). Cut-offs at -40% and 6% of GDP are Heirstone choices



Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators, accessed 2026. Zimbabwe not plotted: multiple currencies, property priced in US\$. Heirstone analysis.

Discount markets, high weight

EGYPT, NIGERIA

Diaspora demand comes in waves after devaluations, and the dollar discount is large while it lasts. State programmes and private developers sell to the same buyers abroad, so pricing in hard currency or indexing to it captures demand. Plan launches for the months after a float, and expect the discount to shrink within about a year, as it did in New Cairo.

Savings markets, high weight

MOROCCO, SENEGAL, CABO VERDE, TUNISIA

Money arrives steadily and buys at stable prices, so there is no discount to time. The diaspora saves at home and visits often, and the homes it buys are more often seasonal. The levers are turning deposits into mortgages for residents and making second homes earn when empty.

Discount markets, lower weight

GHANA, ETHIOPIA

The currency discount is there but the diaspora is a smaller share of the economy. Dollar products serve a narrower buyer base: Ghana's dollar mortgages and Ethiopia's offshore-funded purchase rules are the relevant tools. Recorded flows may still be catching up with actual flows after Ethiopia's 2024 float.

Stable markets, lower weight

KENYA, CÔTE D'IVOIRE, ALGERIA

The diaspora is one buyer segment among several. In Kenya it buys managed apartments and satellite-town plots through developers; in Côte d'Ivoire foreign investment is larger than remittances; in Algeria recorded flows are a small part of the likely total.

NORTH AFRICA

North Africa: one coast, three diaspora economies

Egypt

Egypt has the largest diaspora money pool in Africa, US\$36.5bn in the year to June 2025 and US\$37.5bn in the first eleven months of 2025, and the most developed state programmes among our twelve markets for offering land and homes to citizens abroad. Its diaspora lives mostly in the Gulf: CAPMAS counted 6.23 million of the 9.47 million Egyptians abroad in Arab countries at the end of 2016, and the Ministry of Emigration now puts the total at about 14 million. That makes Riyadh, Jeddah, Dubai and Doha Egypt's main overseas sales floors. Two additions would sharpen the picture: publishing the census line on homes closed by households abroad by governorate, which would show where diaspora homes sit, and a registry figure that separates diaspora purchases from Gulf buyers in the US\$1.5bn of property exports.

Morocco

Morocco's diaspora sends steady money (MAD 122bn in 2025, up 2.6%, and 9.9% higher in the first half of 2026),

banks it in dirhams and buys with state aid. Its homes cluster in emigrant regions and stand empty outside the summer. Paris fairs matter less than they did: SMAP Immo expected 50,000 visitors in 2011 and drew 41,400 in 2012; its 2022 edition expected about 35,000. Gross yields of 8.57% in Tangier, against 4.76% in seasonal Agadir, suggest the return on a home that is let all year.

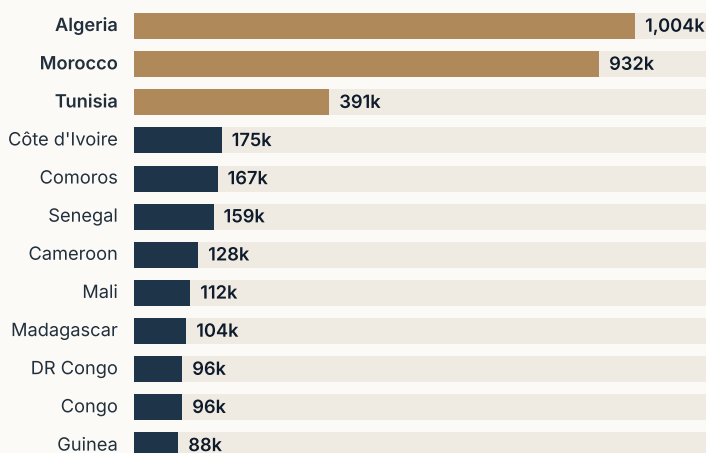
Tunisia and Algeria

Tunisia received US\$3.3bn in 2024, 6.3% of GDP and 65% more than in 2015; sending money from France cost 5.50% on average. Algeria's recorded flows are small for the size of its diaspora. Algerian-born immigrants are the largest group in France, about 1.0 million, yet recorded remittances were only US\$1.8bn in 2024, 0.7% of GDP, and the one formal France-Algeria channel surveyed cost 45.13%. Official data cannot size Algerian diaspora housing demand; any developer or lender doing so will need its own survey.

EXHIBIT 21

North Africans are the three largest African-born groups in France

Immigrants living in France by country of birth, 2025, thousands



Source: INSEE, L'essentiel sur les immigrés et les étrangers (2026 update): published shares of 7.97 million immigrants. Heirstone calculation.

6.23m

Egyptians living in Arab countries at the end of 2016, out of 9.47 million abroad (CAPMAS)

45.13%

average cost of sending US\$200 from France to Algeria in Q3 2025, one bank surveyed

8.57%

gross rental yield in Tangier, against 4.76% in seasonal Agadir (Global Property Guide, 2026)

WEST AFRICA

Nigeria and Ghana sell to the diaspora through developers; Senegal through the state and savings

Nigeria

Nigeria combines the largest remittance-to-FDI multiple in the Monitor (9.9x) with the steepest currency fall (-74% since 2021), which makes it the clearest discount market south of the Sahara. Estimates of the housing deficit range from 15 million units (government, 2026) to more than 28 million (CAHF). Developers sell off-plan to buyers abroad over 12 to 24 months; the Federal Housing Authority plans a Diaspora City of over 17,000 units on 675 hectares in Abuja, about 25 units per hectare. The central bank's non-resident BVN, introduced in May 2025, lets Nigerians abroad open accounts remotely, and the UK corridor is one of the cheapest in Africa at 1.96%. Rents in Lekki and Ikeja rose more than 200% in four years (CAHF), which supports the case for buying to let.

Ghana

Ghana has allowed dual nationality since 2000, so most of its diaspora buys as citizens. It has the most developed dollar mortgage offer in the Monitor, and Republic Bank reports more than 300 home buyers financed in two years. Developers sell in London and Philadelphia, and organisers now steer buyers from plots to finished homes. The 2019 Year of Return campaign coincided with a 45% rise in airport arrivals for the year, according to press reports. Premium Accra land costs US\$428 to 534 per sq m (CAHF).

Senegal and francophone West Africa

Senegal received a record FCFA 2,211bn (about US\$3.6bn) in 2024 according to the BCEAO, about 12% of GDP. France to Senegal is among Africa's cheapest corridors at 2.41%, against 7.90% from Italy. The state has added a diaspora bond tranche and a housing quota to the Paris and Marseille property fairs, which reported over 2,500 visitors in 2017. Dakar is short of about 150,000 homes on the government's figure, only 38.8% of its households own their home, and a 2019 CAHF study found that only 10% of low-income Dakar owners used bank finance. Côte d'Ivoire's remittances rose five-fold from 2015 to US\$1.8bn in 2024 but remain below FDI of US\$3.1bn. Mali's have been flat at about US\$1.1bn since 2018. Comoros, with remittances worth 20.8% of GDP and 57 times its FDI in 2023, is the most diaspora-dependent francophone economy in our data; about 167,000 Comorian-born immigrants live in France.

Cabo Verde

Cabo Verde's escudo moved less than 5% against the dollar from 2021 to 2025, remittances are 12.3% of GDP and 29% of homes are seasonal or vacant. Praia has 22.6% more dwellings than households. The cheapest new formal house costs CVE 3.5m (US\$34,130 at CAHF's rate), high for the region. Diaspora purchasing power may help explain that, but the data do not allow it to be tested.

1.96%

average cost of sending US\$200 from the UK to Nigeria, Q3 2025

10.5%

lowest dollar mortgage rate for buyers abroad in Ghana, against 22 to 28% for cedi loans (Ownkey)

**FCFA
2,211bn**

Senegal's record remittances in 2024, about 12% of GDP (BCEAO)

167,000

Comorian-born immigrants in France, for remittances worth a fifth of GDP at home

EAST AND SOUTHERN AFRICA

In East Africa the diaspora buys through developers and banks; in Mogadishu it funds a building boom

Kenya

Kenya's remittances reached US\$5.04bn in 2025 but grew only 1.9%, which the central bank called the weakest growth in more than 15 years, and January to August 2026 was 0.7% below the year before. North America supplies 58%, just as the United States introduced a 1% excise on cash-funded transfers from January 2026. Kenyans abroad have been able to keep their citizenship since 2010 and buy as citizens. Six banks are cited as offering diaspora mortgages, mostly in shillings at 9% to 13% when refinanced by the Kenya Mortgage Refinance Company, according to a mortgage guide. The market is selective: Westlands and Upper Hill apartments fell 2.8% and 2.5% in the first quarter of 2026 on oversupply, while Karen and Lavington houses were 14% up on a year earlier. A Nairobi pipeline of about 160,000 units means diaspora buyers need to choose schemes with a track record of letting.

Ethiopia

Ethiopia's recorded remittances jumped to US\$7.1bn after the July 2024 float. It does not allow dual nationality, so foreign nationals of Ethiopian origin hold an origin ID that gives them the right to own property. Proclamation 1388/2025 lets other foreigners own one house with at least US\$150,000 of offshore funds; land remains state-owned. Commercial Bank of Ethiopia

launched an ETB 50bn diaspora loan package in 2025 (about US\$0.6bn at the 2024 average rate) and opens diaspora foreign-currency accounts in dollars, sterling or euros, with a US\$5,000 minimum for fixed deposits. About 72% of urban homes are built informally (CAHF).

Zimbabwe

The World Bank records US\$3.5bn of remittances in 2024; government data cited by Al Jazeera show US\$2.45bn in 2025, so the measures differ. Property is priced in dollars. ZimProp Expo puts the average Harare home at US\$240,000 after an 80% rise in five years, and estate agents say up to half of high-end sales go to Zimbabweans abroad. Neither claim is independently verified.

Somalia

Somalia shows diaspora money without a property market to measure it. Remittances are put at 26% of GDP in 2022 by CAHF and at about 15% in 2023 by the World Bank, as cited by AFP. CAHF links a construction spree in Mogadishu to diaspora money and estimates that land prices there may have risen as much as tenfold since 2012; the city's mayor counts more than 6,000 buildings put up in five years. For Hargeisa, a city of about 1.2 million by 2019, a Brenthurst Foundation study put regional remittances at about US\$780m a year in 2013-14, about 30% of which went into capital or financial investment.

58%

of Kenya's 2025 remittances came from North America

US\$150,000

minimum offshore investment for a foreigner to buy a house in Ethiopia under Proclamation 1388/2025

10X

possible rise in Mogadishu land prices since 2012 (CAHF estimate)

CHAPTER 7

07
What to do

The diaspora buyer will keep coming: it has the money and, in most markets, the citizenship. Outcomes depend on whether products and payment plans are designed around how it actually buys and uses a home, and on whether the statistics can see it.

FOR

Governments, land agencies and investment promotion agencies

Count the diaspora home. Add a census line for homes closed because the household lives abroad, as Egypt does, publish it by region, and report the diaspora share of every state housing programme.

Treat closed and seasonal homes as supply. Pilot letting and management schemes for diaspora-owned homes in new cities and coastal towns alongside new dollar launches.

Attach building milestones or staged building packages to plots sold abroad, so that buyers can complete their homes from a distance.

Publish diaspora investment data alongside FDI: over ten years, remittances exceeded net FDI in ten of our twelve markets.

FOR

Developers

Choose the buyer type before designing the product. A plot builder, a summer family and a remote investor want different units, terms and services.

Price in hard currency, or index instalments to it where the law allows, and plan launches for the months after a devaluation and around the summer return.

Show progress and title remotely, hold deposits in escrow, and sell a management contract with the unit for the months the owner is away.

Build feasibility on registry, bank and programme data, and treat fair sales claims as marketing.

FOR

Banks, insurers and payment providers

Lend in the currency the buyer earns. Ghana's dollar mortgages at 10.5% to 12% sit far below its 22% to 28% cedi loans, according to a comparison site.

Offer property-sized transfers with published prices. Retail corridors range from 1.46% to 45% on France to Morocco, and no public series covers deposit-sized payments.

Link diaspora deposits to housing finance: Moroccan diaspora deposits equal 89% of the housing-loan book.

Insure completion and title for buyers who cannot visit the site.

FOR

Development finance institutions, pension funds and asset managers

Underwrite currency and occupancy as well as rent. Nairobi suburban houses gained about 9% in dollars in 18 years.

Back managed rental platforms for diaspora-owned stock in emigrant regions and coastal towns.

Support diaspora savings products tied to housing. Senegal's 2025 savings bond with a diaspora tranche raised about US\$773m across the whole issue in three weeks, half as much again as its target.

Fund the missing statistics: census vacancy by reason and registry data on buyers' residence.

A HEIRSTONE TEST

Six questions before a diaspora launch

These are the questions we would put to any developer, land agency or lender planning a product for buyers abroad, whether a dollar plot round in Egypt, a managed apartment block in Nairobi or a second-home scheme in northern Morocco.

Each draws on evidence in this report. The third matters most where censuses already count large numbers of closed and seasonal homes.

How Heirstone works on these questions

We help developers, landowners, lenders and governments decide what to build, for whom and at what price: market and demand studies by buyer segment, highest-and-best-use and site selection, feasibility models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), pricing and payment-plan design, and benchmarks of the kind in this report.

Get in touch

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- 1 **Which of the four buyers is it for?**
A plot builder wants serviced land and staged building; a summer family wants a compact home and someone to look after it; a remote investor wants a finished, let unit; a dollar saver wants a safe place for money now and a home later. One product rarely serves two of them well.
- 2 **What currency is the price in, and where is the exchange rate in its cycle?**
New Cairo asking prices rose 89% in pounds in under three years, a 38% discount for buyers paying in dollars, and dollar prices recovered 20% within fifteen months of the float. A launch priced in local currency after a float sells a discount that may not last; a launch priced in dollars before a float may be overtaken by cheaper resale stock.
- 3 **Who uses the home when the owner is away?**
Egypt counted 1.159 million homes closed by households abroad; Morocco's emigrant regions hold about a quarter of their urban stock as secondary homes. A letting or management service can give the owner an income and keep the home occupied for more of the year.
- 4 **Can the buyer check progress and title from abroad?**
Ghanaian organisers now steer buyers to finished homes because land acquisition and site supervision are hard from a distance. Remote reporting, escrow and clean title are part of the product.
- 5 **What does the money cost to send?**
On France to Morocco, a US\$200 transfer cost from 1.46% to 45.07% depending on the provider. For some buyers a partnership with a low-cost channel may matter as much as a price discount.
- 6 **Will the sales channel produce evidence or only marketing?**
Fair organisers report sales on their own definitions. Track reservations, transfers and completions, and plan on those.

NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Diaspora buyer: a citizen or person of national origin living abroad who buys land or housing in the country of origin. **MRE:** Marocains résidant à l'étranger, Moroccans resident abroad.

Remittances: personal remittances received as defined by the World Bank (balance-of-payments data), unless a national source is named. **Net FDI:** net inflows of foreign direct investment, balance-of-payments basis. **Idle stock:** dwellings recorded by a census as vacant, closed, secondary or seasonal. **Asking price:** an advertised price, not a transaction price.

Method

Figures are as published by the sources named, for the period stated. Heirstone analysis is labelled and uses only the inputs shown. Remittance-to-FDI multiples sum ten years of both series. Dollar price series convert asking prices at the rate stated by the source (Cairo) or at World Bank annual averages (Nairobi, Lagos). Moroccan regional shares are derived from HCP's published shares of national stock. Where sources conflict (Bait Al Watan proceeds, Egypt's 2017 vacancy totals, Nigeria's housing deficit, Zimbabwe's remittances) we give the range or both figures. Industry and fair claims are attributed and treated as unverified. No registry in the markets studied publishes the diaspora share of transactions, Lagos and Accra lack a usable price index, and the 2009 World Bank and 2025 KNBS surveys of remittance use in Kenya measure different things and cannot be read as a trend.

Exchange rates used

CURRENCY	PER US\$, 2025 AVERAGE UNLESS STATED
Egyptian pound (EGP)	49.23
Nigerian naira (NGN)	1,518.38
Kenyan shilling (KES)	129.30
Ghanaian cedi (GHS)	12.56
Moroccan dirham (MAD)	9.35 (2021: 8.99)
CFA franc (XOF)	581.93 (2024: 606.35)
Cabo Verde escudo (CVE)	97.86
Ethiopian birr (ETB), 2024	82.60
UAE dirham (AED), peg	3.6725

World Bank, PA.NUS.FCRF (official rate, annual average), accessed 2026.

Sources by chapter

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CHAPTER 7

Recommendations and the six-question test draw on the evidence and sources above.

Use of this report

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